and started digging in. These PLA locations were at lower heights and directly under our observation. As such, they were of no threat to us, but if they were to come up in strength and try to outflank or surround our localities, then we would have to take action. The situation was tense and nearing breaking point. While this was underway, there was a Hot Line message from the PLA at about 1730 hours, requesting a Flag Meeting at the Chushul–Moldo Meeting Point. There was no time to lose. Brig Gill[4], Cdr 114 Inf Bde, the reserve Brigade of the Corps, showed exceptional initiative in immediately moving forward to the Meeting Point all by himself, knowing well that tempers were running high and that he might get a hostile response. He was met by his counterpart of the Border Defence Regiment, who said that we should abide by the strategic guidance of our leaders, that they don't want war and that we should freeze all movement till the next SHMCL meeting. However, their actions on ground belied his words. When this was brought to his notice, he said that he would try his best to contain the situation but that since these troops were 'from the outside', it was proving to be difficult. The meeting lasted from about 1830 to 2300 hours and before breaking off, Brig Gill reiterated that they should stop all forward movement and not try to close in, or else we would open fire. It was a tense night for all of us. Earlier in the evening, in the area of Gurung Hill on the South bank, one JCO of 7 VIKAS (Special Frontier Force), Nyima Tenzin, was killed when he stepped on a vintage mine while rallying his troops. He was posthumously awarded the Asadharan Suraksha Seva Praman Patra.[5]

The daylight hours of 31 August saw a lot of movement on the PLA side, even as we consolidated our own position. Troops dug down, prepared field defences and laid barbed-wire obstacles about 50 m forward of their positions. This was to be

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